

Corex CardScan Executive

For a digital rolodex

The CardScan Executive is a compact colour scanner that will scan business cards and upload their contents into a database on your PC. The device fits snugly in the palm of your hand and is

CD and you're all done.

Once the device is installed, launch the Card-Scan program, simply feed in the cards one at a time and see the software upload all the information, field-wise in to your database in a jiffy.

Apart from synchronising with handhelds and mobile phones, CardScan offers access to CardScan.net, where users can access their business card data-base via any Web browser.

Overall, the CardScan is an innovative product, combining a colour scanner and database management software, however, the price is quite steep.

SPECIFICATIONS

Windows 98/Me/2000/XP compatible, Scans in colour and monochrome, measures 6.75x4.75x2 inches, connects through USB, can synchronise with handheld devices

Corex CardScan Executive		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Price: Rs 27,490
Contact: Net Spider
Phone: 022-28633514
Fax: 011-26826053
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Web site: www.netspiderindia.com

Creative WebCam Pro

Spot the world!

This Web cam sports a very slim design and can be tilted to around 135 degrees and turned on its axis, which allows shots to be taken in any direction. The base stand is designed such that it can be used with desktop PCs as well as laptops—it can hold on to any laptop with a 0.5-inch thick screen.

It has a CMOS sensor, which has a true resolution of 640x480 and can

be further interpolated to 1026x768 using any image enhancing software. It can also record video at a maximum of 15 fps at 640x480 resolution, which is good enough quality for sharing the clip. It supports 24-bit colour, which makes images look sharp and crisp. The pictures are saved as JPEG images.

The Web-Cam Pro can be connected to the PC using the USB connection and

the microphone allows video conferencing.

The camera is pretty simple to install and configure—Windows automatically detects it, but you will need the driver CDs to install the driver. It shows good response to background lighting—the images are clear, showing no grains or haziness in natural light but with low background lighting, the image

Price: Rs 4,499
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becomes a bit dark.

Given its features and performance, this camera is a good buy.

SPECIFICATIONS

CMOS sensor, 640x480 true resolution, 1028x768 maximum interpolated resolution, maximum 30 fps video recording, USB 1.1 interface

Creative WebCam PRO		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Zoltrix Cool Disk - 128 MB USB pen drive

The pen is mighty

In today's data centric world, we crave for devices which are easy to use, fast, portable and can hold more data. One such device is the portable 128 MB USB storage pen drive, named Cool Disk.

The drive uses Flash RAM technology and the package includes a leather cover, a neck sling, a USB extension cable and driver CDs. The drive gets detected in Windows XP/2000 and the drivers are loaded automatically, whereas for Windows 98/Me the drivers are provided in the accompanying CD. One interesting feature of the drive is that you can use it as a bootable disk if your motherboard supports USB device booting.

The drive can be password-protected for safekeeping. To prevent the data from being accidentally overwritten, it also has a write protect switch similar to floppies.

Price: Rs 5,500 for 128 MB
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On the performance front, the disk takes around 5 minutes to transfer 128 MB of data. However, it does seem to be a bit slow compared to USB drives. Being a Flash RAM drive, data integrity and reliability is quite high.

Priced at Rs 5,500, this 128 MB drive offers good value for money—other such drives cost nearly Rs 2,000 more for half the capacity.

SPECIFICATIONS

128 MB capacity, Windows 98/SE/Me/2000/XP, USB power supply (4.5 V to 5.5 V), USB 1.0/1.1 interface, data retention of over 10 years, available in capacities ranging from 32 MB to 384 MB

System Requirements: IBM PC or Notebook computer with USB port, Windows 98/Me/2000/XP

Zoltrix Cool Disk - 128 MB USB pen drive		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	